BITCOIN FOR THE Arts

PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL · OCTOBER 2026

BITCOIN FOR THE ARTS × CITADEL CREDIT UNION

A proposed multi-year founding partnership to bring sound money education, artist grants, and live culture to the members and communities Citadel serves.

Prepared for the Citadel Cares leadership team

PEOPLE HELPING PEOPLE, WITH SOUND MONEY

THE OPPORTUNITY

MEMBERS ARE ASKING ABOUT BITCOIN. WHO WILL THEY LEARN IT FROM?

More members hold bitcoin or are curious about it every year. When their credit union isn't part of that conversation, they learn from exchanges, apps, and social media, and the relationship moves with them. A credit union that teaches sound money plainly and responsibly becomes the trusted place members turn to.

01 · WHO WE SERVE

Independent working artists

Freelancers, small-business owners, and creative entrepreneurs with irregular income, chronically underserved by traditional arts funding and by retail banking.

02 · WHAT THEY NEED

Real financial education

How money works, how to manage income that comes in bursts, how to protect savings, and how new payment rails like bitcoin and Lightning work.

03 · WHY A CREDIT UNION

Shared values

Member-owned, community-first, and built to serve people the big institutions overlook. That is the same community Bitcoin For The Arts was built to serve.

WHY NOW

BRIDGING CREDIT UNIONS INTO THE SOUND MONEY ECOSYSTEM

Credit unions don't need to become bitcoin companies to lead here. They need members who understand what bitcoin is, how to stay safe, and how it fits beside their savings, credit, and retirement planning. That understanding is what Bitcoin For The Arts teaches.

The NCUA has confirmed that federally insured credit unions may work with third-party providers of digital asset services, within applicable law and with sound risk management (Letter to Credit Unions 21-CU-16). Education is the first, lowest-risk step.

01 **Education first.** Members learn the fundamentals from a 501(c)(3), with no products sold and no investment advice.

02 **Trust stays home.** The credit union is the name on the classroom, not an exchange.

03 **A younger, entrepreneurial audience.** Creative freelancers are the members most credit unions want and rarely reach.

04 **Ready when you are.** If the credit union later explores digital asset services, its members already have the foundation.

Credit union expertise on our board. Kyle Shirkness spent 19+ years in credit unions, most recently as Director of Operational Excellence and Innovation at Citadel Credit Union, and presented "Bitcoin: The Credit Union Infrastructure Upgrade" at EDGE 2026.

ALIGNMENT WITH CITADEL CARES

WHERE BITCOIN FOR THE ARTS MEETS CREDIT UNION COMMUNITY GIVING

Most credit union giving programs focus on the same four areas. Bitcoin For The Arts directly serves three, each with outcomes you can report.

DIRECT

Financial literacy

Live classes on how money works, saving, security, and new payment rails, built for people with irregular income.

DIRECT

Education

The Share Your Bitcoin Journey podcast, artist Stories, our Substack, and open-source class materials, reaching a national audience.

DIRECT

Community and economic development

Micro-grants paid directly to working artists, and live cultural programs that bring paid work and audiences to local communities.

INDIRECT

Health and wellness

Not a primary program. Financial stability is a foundation of personal wellbeing, and our classes address financial stress directly.

ABOUT US

BITCOIN FOR THE ARTS

A New York 501(c)(3) nonprofit and the first nonprofit paying artists exclusively in bitcoin, through micro-grants, sound money education, and live programming.

GRANTS

Micro-grants for creation costs, production, studio time, and travel, paid in bitcoin directly to the artist.

EDUCATION

Live sound money classes for artists and the public, plus free webinars and guides at bitcoinforthearts.org.

MEDIA

The Share Your Bitcoin Journey podcast on Apple, Spotify, and YouTube, artist Stories, and our Substack.

LIVE PROGRAMS

Bitcoin Arts Park and artist programming at national bitcoin events, with every artist on the bill paid.

EVERY DOLLAR, BY RULE

55% to artist grants · 30% to programs · 10% to operations · 5% to the HODL Vault, our long-term bitcoin reserve.

RADICAL TRANSPARENCY

Board minutes, governance policies, and financial records are published at bitcoinforthearts.org/transparency.

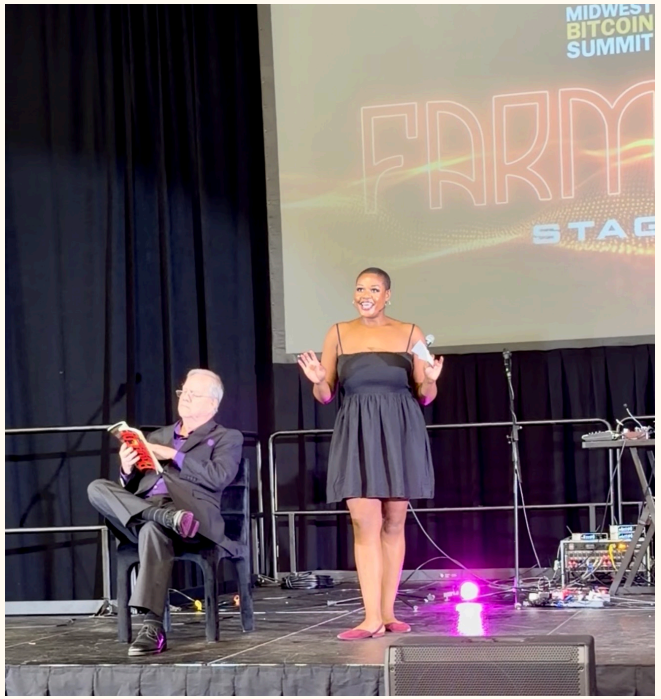
TRACK RECORD

BITCOIN ARTS PARK, COLUMBUS

In September 2026 we opened Bitcoin Arts Park at the Midwest Bitcoin Summit: live music, theatre with youth performers, live painting, a cinema slate, and a silent auction for artists. Every artist on the bill was paid.







Bitcoin Arts Park, Midwest Bitcoin Summit, Columbus, Ohio, September 23 to 24, 2026.

FLAGSHIP ACTIVATIONS · 2027

WHERE YOUR NAME SHOWS UP

JANUARY 15 TO 16 · NAPLES, FLORIDA

BitcoinDay Naples

Arts programming, a main-stage panel, and an artist talk with a live Lightning payment, before about 200 investors, builders, and capital allocators.

JULY 14 TO 15 · NASHVILLE, TENNESSEE

Bitcoin For The Arts Park Nashville

Two stages and a market row across from the Bitcoin Conference, during one of the largest bitcoin gatherings in the country.

YEAR-ROUND · ONLINE AND IN PERSON

Sound money classes

Our class series, live online for a national audience, with in-person sessions that can be hosted in your branches or community spaces.

PRESENTING SPONSOR RECOGNITION

Stage screens · Signage across the Park · Livestream credit where the event streams · Printed programs · The produced recap video · Recognition in our newsletter, Substack, and podcast

PARTNERSHIP ARCHITECTURE

THREE TIERS, ONE PARTNERSHIP

Every tier renews annually and produces outcomes you can report in your annual community impact disclosure. All amounts are per year. Choose the tier that fits your 2027 budget and priorities.

TIER 1 · ANCHOR PARTNER

$50,000 to $100,000

Presenting sponsor of Bitcoin Arts Park, a named artist grant fund, a co-hosted workshop series, and a member offer for artists.

TIER 2 · PROGRAM SPONSOR

$15,000 to $25,000

Name-sponsor one flagship program: Bitcoin Arts Park at one event, the artist Stories and podcast suite, or the class series.

TIER 3 · COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

$5,000 to $15,000

A local workshop cohort, regional artist grants, or an employee mentor program, with volunteer hours from your team.

TIER 1 · $50,000 TO $100,000 PER YEAR

ANCHOR PARTNER

For a credit union that wants to lead this partnership, with the most visibility, measurable community impact, and a direct line to a new generation of members.

01 **Presenting sponsor, Bitcoin Arts Park.** Named presenting sponsorship at Bitcoin For The Arts Park Nashville, July 2027, with full on-site and digital recognition.

02 **The Citadel Cares Sovereign Artist Fund.** A named grant track awarding $500 to $2,000 micro-grants to working artists, a directly reportable outcome with named recipients.

03 **Artist Financial Wellness and Sound Money workshops.** Quarterly sessions co-hosted with your financial professionals, who cover budgeting, credit, and savings while we cover how money works and how bitcoin works. In person in your service area and streamed nationally.

04 **A member offer for artists.** Your credit union can extend a membership offer to artists in our community. We share it as a resource in our programs. Artists opt in themselves, and we never share their information.

TIERS 2 AND 3

PROGRAM AND COMMUNITY TIERS

TIER 2 · $15,000 TO $25,000 / YEAR

Program sponsor: choose one

- **Bitcoin Arts Park** at one event, with on-site presenting credit, digital recognition, and recap video placement.
- **Artist Stories**: the podcast, written profiles, and Substack, with credit on every episode and publication.
- **Sound money class series**, with co-hosting rights and your professionals featured as experts.

TIER 3 · $5,000 TO $15,000 / YEAR, PLUS VOLUNTEERS

Community engagement: choose one

- **Local workshop cohort**: one class series in your service area, co-led with your staff.
- **Regional artist grants**: named grants for artists in your field of membership, reportable per recipient.
- **Employee mentor program**: your professionals paired with artists for financial mentorship.

THE RETURN

WHAT YOU RECEIVE AT EVERY TIER

REPORTABLE IMPACT

Direct alignment with financial literacy, education, and community and economic development, ready for your annual impact report.

MEASURABLE OUTCOMES

Artists served, classes delivered, grants awarded, and attendance, reported back to you in writing after each program.

VISIBILITY

Your name in front of national bitcoin audiences at Bitcoin Arts Park, and in our classes, podcast, newsletter, and Substack.

A NEW GENERATION OF MEMBERS

Young, entrepreneurial creatives that traditional credit union marketing rarely reaches, meeting you through education first.

LEADERSHIP

Among the first credit unions to partner with a bitcoin-native arts nonprofit, with a story no other institution in your market can tell.

A FOUNDING SEAT

As a founding partner, you help shape the program's structure, schedule, and curriculum with our leadership.

BUILT FOR COMPLIANCE

HOW WE PROTECT YOUR BRAND

We know a credit union's compliance and risk teams will review any bitcoin partnership. These terms are built into every tier.

- **Education, not advice.** Our classes are financial education. We give no investment advice and sell no products.
- **No product endorsements.** We recognize sponsors by name and logo. We don't promote rates, products, or comparisons.
- **Your review.** Co-branded materials and co-hosted class content are shared with your team in advance.
- **Artist privacy.** We never sell or share artist or member data. Any member offer is opt-in by the artist.
- **Full transparency.** Public board minutes, governance policies, and financial records, plus a written impact report for each sponsor.
- **Charitable gift.** Sponsorships are gifts to a 501(c)(3) and are receipted with the value of any benefits stated.

NEXT STEPS

THE ASK

We invite Citadel to enter a multi-year founding partnership with Bitcoin For The Arts, at the tier that best fits your 2027 community giving budget and priorities. We'd welcome the chance to present to your leadership and community giving team at a time that suits you.

CONTACT

Dion Wilson

Founder and Executive Director
Bitcoin For The Arts, Inc.
dionwilson@bitcoinforthearts.org

CREDIT UNION PARTNERSHIPS

Kyle Shirkness, CBE

Board Member, Bitcoin For The Arts
Senior Partner, The Bitcoin Pivot
19+ years in credit unions
kyle.shirkness@bitcoinforthearts.org

LEGAL STANDING

501(c)(3) nonprofit

Bitcoin For The Arts, Inc., New York
EIN 41-2642260
bitcoinforthearts.org/transparency